This work done is stored as potential energy in bar magnet at an angle θ when it is rotated from θ′ to θ and it can be written as

$$U = -p_m B(\cos\theta - \cos\theta') \quad (3.26)$$

In fact, the equation (3.26) gives the difference in potential energy between the angular positions θ′ and θ. We can choose the reference point θ′ = 90°, so that second term in the equation becomes zero and the equation (3.26) can be written as

$$U = -p_m B\,(\cos\theta) \quad (3.27)$$

The potential energy stored in a bar magnet in a uniform magnetic field is given by

$$U = -\vec{p}_m \cdot \vec{B} \quad (3.28)$$

Case 1

(i) If θ = 0°, then

$$U = -p_m B\,(\cos 0^\circ) = -p_m \mathrm{B}$$

(ii) If θ = 180°, then

$$U = -p_m B\,(\cos 180^\circ) = p_m \mathrm{B}$$

We can infer from the above two results, the potential energy of the bar magnet is minimum when it is aligned along the external magnetic field and maximum when the bar magnet is aligned anti-parallel to external magnetic field.

EXAMPLE 3.8

Consider a magnetic dipole which on switching ON external magnetic field orient only in two possible ways i.e., one along the direction of the magnetic field (parallel to the field) and another anti-parallel to magnetic field. Compute the energy for the possible orientation. Sketch the graph.

Solution

Let $\vec{p}_m$ be the dipole and before switching ON the external magnetic field, there is no orientation. Therefore, the energy U = 0.

As soon as external magnetic field is switched ON, the magnetic dipole orient parallel (θ = 0°) to the magnetic field with energy,

$$U_{parallel} = U_{minimum} = -p_m B\cos 0$$
$$U_{parallel} = -p_m B$$

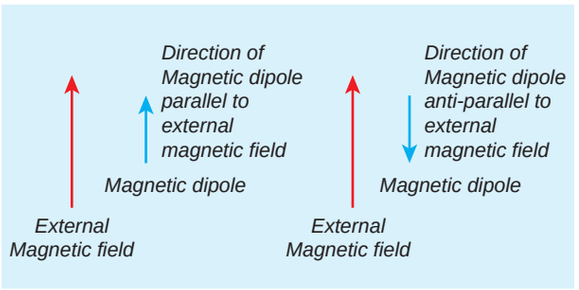
since cos 0° = 1

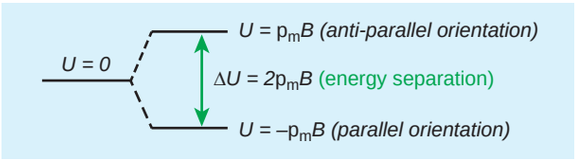
Otherwise, the magnetic dipole orients anti-parallel (θ = 180°) to the magnetic field with energy,

$$U_{anti-parallel} = U_{maximum} = -p_m B\cos 180$$

$$\Rightarrow U_{anti-parallel} = p_m B$$

since cos 180° = -1





3.3.2 Tangent law and Tangent Galvanometer

Tangent Galvanometer (Figure 3.21) is a device used to measure very small currents. It is a moving magnet type galvanometer. Its working is based on tangent law.

UNIT-3(XII-Physics_Vol-1).indd 146 04-03-2019 10:33:47